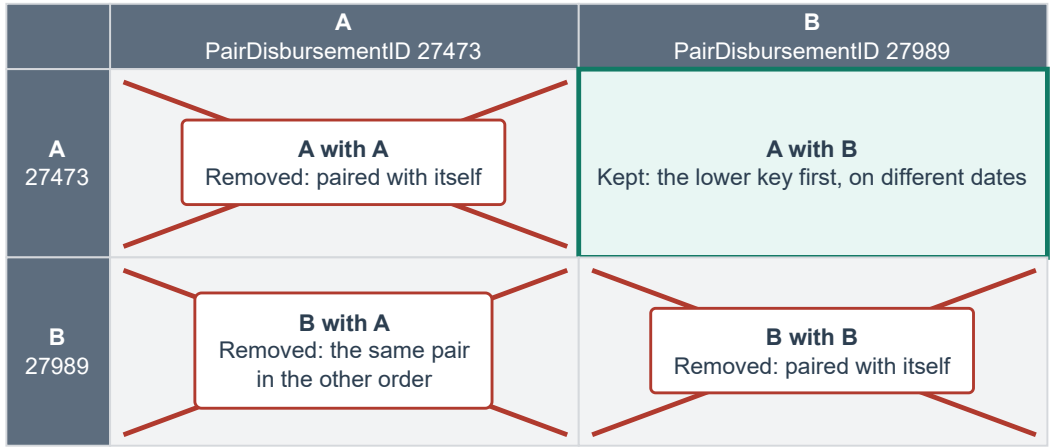
Two payments of one supplier and one amount, on different dates

Payment A, the lower key
DisbursementID 27473
SupplierID 9, Amount 163.05
PaymentDate 2026-06-01

Payment B, the higher key
DisbursementID 27989
SupplierID 9, Amount 163.05
PaymentDate 2026-06-04

Merge Payments with itself on SupplierID and Amount: an inner join keeps every combination



DisbursementID < PairDisbursementID
Keeps the lower key first. It removes A with A and B with B, whose keys are equal, and B with A, whose left key is the higher.

PaymentDate <> PairPaymentDate
Keeps pairs on different dates. It removes A with A and B with B, which are on the same date, and leaves A with B and B with A.

The two payments are the closest pair of the dataset, 3 days apart. In the dataset the merge returns 40,090 rows: 39,864 payments paired with themselves and 113 pairs in both orders. The dates alone leave 226, each pair twice; the keys alone leave 113, because no two payments of one supplier and one amount share a date. The exercise asks for both filters, so a roll does not break it.